

CHAPTER SIX

STAFFING

6.1 The Meaning of Staffing:

Staffing can be defined as:

- The processing of obtaining and maintaining capable and competent people to fill all positions from top managements to operative level.

Staffing processes:

1. Human Resource Planning:

Human resource planning is the process by which managers ensure that they have the right number and kind of people who are capable to effectively and efficiently perform their tasks, at the right time and place.

It involves analysis of:

- Current and expected skill needs of the organization (internal factors); and,
- Factors such as the labour market, government regulations, the labour union etc. (External environment).

The Basic Human Resource Planning Steps

These steps include:

1. Current Assessment / Human Resource Inventory

- Human resource inventory helps the managers to assess what talents and skills are currently available.

The following aspects should be considered in this stage:

Job Analysis:

It is the process of collecting, analyzing and coordinating information about jobs.

Primary purpose of job analysis is to

- Determine the duties and responsibilities of the job.
- Determine the kind of person needed to fill each job
- The outcomes of job analysis are job description and job specification.

Aspects of Job Analysis:

I. Job description

- It is a written statement of what job holder does, how it is done, and why it is done.
- It describes the content of the job.
- It is a written document of the duties and responsibilities of a job.

II. Job specification

- Focuses on the person
- It states the minimum acceptable qualification and experience that a jobholder must possess to perform a given task effectively and efficiently.
- It identifies the knowledge, skills and abilities needed to do the job effectively.

Eg. A job specification for a marketing manager might read:

- The position requires: MBA (specialization in marketing)
- Eight years experience in sales and minimum of three years supervisory experience,

2. Developing Future Programme / companion of forecast inventory

- It provides projections of future human resource needs and availability.
- After assessing current capabilities and future needs, managers are able to estimate shortages:

- Both in number and in type.

2. Recruitment

- It is the process of locating, identifying and attracting capable applicants.
- It is also making potential candidates interested in particular job positions and apply for it.

Sources of recruitment

- There are two sources of recruitment

i. **Internal source** - includes the existing work force of the organization.

Merits of Internal sources:

- Motivational and job satisfaction advantage (provision of continuity employment)
- Enhancing morale and creation of a sense of security among workers.
- Less expensive - minimizes training or orientation cost
- Easy to apply - performance of employees can be easily evaluated, etc.

Demerits of Internal sources

- Limits the pool of talent available to the organization
- Discourages new blood from entering the organization
- Successful people are promoted until they finally reach a level in which they are unable to perform adequately.

ii. **External source of recruitment**

It is used:

- When an organization has exhausted internal sources;

- When internal sources are found to be unsuitable; or
- When it becomes necessary to fill vacant positions with new employees.

Major alternative external sources:

a) **Employees' referrals (word of mouth):** It refers to encouraging employees to recommend capable and skilled persons to fill the available vacancies.

Advertising: vacancies can be advertised in daily newspapers, employment newsmagazine, etc.

b) **Educational institutions:** New employees can be recruited from colleges and universities.

c) **Employment agencies:** Employment agencies maintain a detailed record of job seekers and refer the candidate with appropriate qualification to the required employers.

Decruitment - It is a labor supply controlling approach commonly applied when it becomes necessary to reduce the organization's surplus labour force.

Methods of Decruitment

- **Attrition** - not filling openings created
- **Early retirement** - retiring older employees before their normal retirement date providing incentives.
- **Firing** - permanent involuntary termination of employment.
- **Lay off** - temporary involuntary termination of employment
- **Reduced workweeks** - having employees work fewer hours per week or perform their jobs on part time basis.

3. Selection

- It is the process of deciding which candidates out of the pool of applicants have the abilities, skills, and characteristics that adequately match the job demands.

The selection process

The process usually follows the following stages:

- i. **Conducting a screening interviews**
- ii. **Completing a Blank application form :**
- iii. **Administration of psychological tests.**
 - Psychological tests are systematic procedures for sampling human behavior.
 - They are designed to measure mental alertness, achievement, special aptitude, etc of the candidate.
- iv. **Conducting Evaluation interviews**
 - Evaluation interview attempts to make a careful assessment of the candidate's qualifications for the particular task (Job).
 - The purpose of interview is to have a good overview of the candidate's strengths and weaknesses for the position.
- v. **Background investigation**
 - It is the verification of information obtained from the candidate's blank application form, selection interview, and the resume.
- vi. **Arrangement for physical examination**
 - Checking the candidate's health condition is essential before placing him in a particular job. By this, the employees' physical fitness should be assured.

4. Placement

- The candidate may submit a fitness-certificate after the medical examination is over.
- It is the final step of the selection process.
- Employment letter specifying the place of work, gross payment, hours of work, etc. is given to the candidate.

5. Induction and Orientation

It is the introduction of a new employee to his/her job and the organization.

Objectives of Orientation/ Induction:

- To reduce the initial anxiety
- To familiarize new employees with the job, the work unit and the organization as a whole
- To facilitate the outsider-insider transitions
- To familiarize the employee with the goals and his/her new co-workers
- To introduce the employee with the relevant policies, rules and regulations.

6. Training and Development

- Training is a part of staffing whose purpose is to aid employees in improving performance.
- It is a learning process that involves acquisition of skills, concepts, rules or attitudes to increase the performance of employees.
- It is a continuous process.

The following are some of the factors that should be considered when planning training programmes:

1. Training must be based on organizational and individual needs.

2. Training should address problems that need to be solved
3. Training programs should be based on sound theories of learning
4. Training must be evaluated and modifications in training programs must be made whenever necessary.

Purposes of Training include:

- Improving the quantity of output
- Improving the quality of output
- Lowering cost of waste and maintenance
- Lowering the number of accidents
- Lowering staff turnover and absenteeism
- Increasing job satisfaction.

Methods of Training

The methods of training can be classified into two broad categories:

I. On-the-job training

- It is letting the employees learn while doing.
- The employee is shown to perform the jobs and allowed to do under the supervisor's supervision.
- The following are the common approaches used in arranging on-the-job training.
 - a. **Coaching** - Refers to the assignment of a specific person to act as either an instructor or resource person for the trainee.

- b. **Apprenticeship:** It is a methodology of allowing the trainee to learn and practice by performing the actual task on the job (frequently used to train personnel in some skilled trades - electrician, mechanics, tailors, carpenters etc.).
- c. **Job rotation (cross training):** It is a process of training employees by rotating them through a series of related tasks.
- d. **Vestibule training: Equipment** and procedures similar to those used in the actual job are set up in a special working area (vestibule school). The trainee is then taught in this school how to use the machinery and perform the required job.
- e. **Self-improvement programs:** Refer to acquiring knowledge through additional reading and self-improvement programs.

II. Off the job training

It is training conducted away from the actual work setting.

Common methods of off the job training include the following:

- a. Lecture and classroom instruction
- b. The conference method
- c. Group discussion
- d. **Role playing (psychodrama, social-drama):** It is a type of training where the trainees act out a given role as they would be performing in a stage play
- e. **Case studies:** It is a method of training where the trainees are given cases and are given to identify basic problem and suggest solution.
- f. **Programmed instruction:** It is a method which involves breaking information into meaningful information and rearranging them in a proper sequence to form a learning package. It consists of three functions: -

- Presenting questions, facts, or problems to the learner
- Allowing the trainee to respond
- Providing the necessary feedback on the accuracy of his answer.

g. T-group training (sensitivity training) : It is a process in which several individuals work together for several days for the purpose of building self-awareness, understanding of group processes and greater understanding of interpersonal relationships.

7. Performance Appraisal

Job performance: - Refers to the degree of accomplishment of task that makes an individual's job. It is measured in terms of results. It is periodic and impartial.

Benefits of performance appraisal

- Assists managers to observe their subordinates more closely and do a better job coaching.
- Motivates employees by providing feedback on job performance.
- Achieves better operational results - improved work performance.
- Identifies development needs.
- Provides back up of data for making decisions about employee compensation.
- Reduces favoritism in making managerial decisions about employees.

8. Transfer, (Promotion, Demotion and Separation)

- **Transfer:** is a movement of an employee from one job, section, department staff, place or position to other place where salary, status, and responsibility are the same. It is movement from one job to the other.
- **Promotion:** Moving an employee to a job involving higher pay, status, and thus higher performance requirements.
- **Demotion:** Shift of an employee to a lower position in the hierarchy, salary, and responsibility due to inefficiency and incompetence to fulfill assigned tasks. It causes frustration and leads to a defensive or even aggressive behavior.
- **Separation:** Refers to those factors that bring the termination or ceasing of the relationship between the organization and the employee.

It may result due to:

- resignation
 - Lay-off
 - discharges
 - retirement
- It can be either voluntary or involuntary.

Option	Description
Firing	Permanent involuntary termination
Layoffs	Temporary involuntary termination; may last only a few days or extend to years
Attrition	Not filling openings created by voluntary resignations or normal retirements
Transfers	Moving employees either laterally or downward; usually does not reduce costs but can reduce intraorganizational supply-demand imbalances
Reduced workweeks	Having employees work fewer hours per week, share jobs, or perform their jobs on a part-time basis
Early retirements	Providing incentives to older and more senior employees for retiring before their normal retirement date
Job sharing	Having employees share one full-time position